

**DIRECT / INDIRECT SPEECH (Special Forms)**

**1. Imperatives (Commands/Requests)**

As you just saw with "please proceed," imperatives change significantly.

- Direct: "Sit down!"
- Reported: He **told** me **to sit down**.
- Direct: "Don't touch that!"
- Reported: She **told** him **not to touch** that.
- Direct: "Please help me."
- Reported: He **asked** her **to help** him.

Key: Use a reporting verb (ask, tell, order, request, advise, etc.) + object + **to** + **infinitive**.

**2. Questions**

Questions require special attention because their structure changes from interrogative to declarative.

- **Yes/No Questions:** Use "if" or "whether."
  - Direct: "Are you ready?"
  - Reported: She asked **if** I was ready.
  - Direct: "Do you like coffee?"
  - Reported: He asked **whether** I liked coffee.
- **Wh-Questions (Who, What, Where, When, Why, How):** Keep the wh-word, but follow it with subject + verb (no auxiliary verb inversion).
  - Direct: "Where do you live?"
  - Reported: He asked me **where I lived**. (Not "where did I live?")
  - Direct: "What are you doing?"
  - Reported: She asked him **what he was doing**.

**3. Exclamations and Interjections**

These often-become statements in reported speech, using verbs like "exclaimed," "shouted," "wondered," or "remarked."

- Direct: "What a beautiful day!"
- Reported: He **exclaimed** that it was a beautiful day.
- Direct: "Oh no!"
- Reported: She **cried out** in dismay. / She **exclaimed** with dismay.
- Direct: "Hurrah!"
- Reported: They **shouted** with joy.

## 4. Conditional Sentences

- **Type 1 (Real/Likely):** Changes tense like other sentences.
  - Direct: "If I **win**, I **will buy** a car."
  - Reported: He said that if he **won**, he **would buy** a car.
- **Type 2 (Unreal/Hypothetical Present/Future):** Often remains the same, or the "would" part shifts slightly.
  - Direct: "If I **had** a million dollars, I **would travel** the world."
  - Reported: She said that if she **had** a million dollars, she **would travel** the world. (Often no change)
- **Type 3 (Unreal Past):** Generally **no change**.
  - Direct: "If I **had known**, I **would have helped**."
  - Reported: He said that if he **had known**, he **would have helped**.

## 5. Expressions of Time, Place, and Demonstratives

- **Now → Then / At that moment**
- **Today → That day**
- **Tomorrow → The next day / The following day**
- **Yesterday → The day before / The previous day**
- **Last week → The week before / The previous week**
- **Next month → The following month / The month after**
- **Here → There**
- **This → That**
- **These → Those**

## 6. Verbs in Continuous Form

These follow the general tense shift rules, but the continuous aspect is maintained.

- Direct: "I am working." (Present Continuous)
- Reported: He said he **was working**. (Past Continuous)
- Direct: "I was sleeping." (Past Continuous)
- Reported: She said she **had been sleeping**. (Past Perfect Continuous)

## 7. Situations Where Tense Doesn't Change

While tense shift is a general rule, there are exceptions:

- **General Truths or Scientific Facts:**
  - Direct: "The sun **rises** in the east."
  - Reported: He said that the sun **rises** in the east.
- **Reporting something that is still true or relevant at the time of reporting:**
  - Direct: "I **live** in Paris." (Said last week, and still true now)
  - Reported: She said she **lives** in Paris. (Or "lived," both can be acceptable, but "lives" implies it's still true).
- **Reporting something immediately:** If you report something right after it's said, you might sometimes keep the original tense, especially in informal contexts.
  - Direct: "I'm hungry." (Just said)
  - Reported: He just said he's hungry. (Less common in formal contexts)

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